STUDENT GUIDE

FACULTY OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

IT Project

Year 3

RICHFIELD

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GUIDELINES FOR IT GROUP PROJECT

The IT Project constitutes a major component in most professional programmes. It needs to be carried out with due care and should be executed with seriousness by the students. The project is not only a credit-bearing module of the Diploma/Degree requirements, but also provides a mechanism to demonstrate students' technical skills, abilities, and specialisation.

The project work should compulsorily include the software development. **Physical installations or configuring the LAN/WAN or theoretical projects or study of the systems, which does not involve software development, are strictly not allowed.**

1. OBJECTIVES

The objective of the project is to help the student establish the ability to apply theoretical and practical tools/techniques to solve real life problems.

Students are expected to develop quality software solution. During the development of the project, students should be involved in all the stages of the software development life cycle like requirements gathering, systems analysis, systems design, software development, testing strategies and documentation with an overall emphasis on the development of reliable software systems. The primary emphasis of the project is to understand and gain knowledge of the principles of software engineering practices, to participate and manage a large software engineering projects in future.

2. INTRODUCTION TO THE GROUP PROJECT

For students to successfully complete this project module, they first need to do IT Project Management/Software Engineering. The modules will equip students with the necessary introductory knowledge to successfully carry out a group project. The project module will run concurrently with IT Project Management or Software Engineering. Students will get an opportunity to apply the theoretical framework from IT Project Management or Software Engineering to build a software product.

3. SKILLS

THE INTRODUCTION WILL EQUIP THE LEARNERS WITH NECESSARY SKILLS FOR THEIR FIELD PROJECT AND INCLUDES THE FOLLOWING

- Choose the project to work on.
- Identify the features and attributes of a project; and identify the steps and variables of the project management process.
- Identify the effects of the environment, various socioeconomic and organizational issues, and organizational structure on a project; and
- Identify the critical functions, necessary skills, responsibilities, and challenges of a project manager.
- Identify the participants in the project, the influence of stakeholders on a project, the objectives of the project, benefits of planning for a project, and project constraints.
- Identify the process and benefits of scope definition and verification; develop the work breakdown structure (WBS) and the work package.
- Identify the types of information that stakeholders need to verify the project scope.
- Identify actions involved in controlling changes; and identify the role of a scope change control system.

- Identify project activities and identify the categories of dependencies and dependency relationships.
- Apply project management concepts; start Project, open an existing project file, and navigate different views; use the Project Help features; create and save a new project file; and close a project file and close Project.
- Create a task list in Gantt Chart view.
- Create a Work Breakdown Structure by adjusting task hierarchy.
- Develop the project schedule by using CPM, PERT, project network diagrams, arrow charting, and Gantt charts, identify the benefits of CPM and PERT, the critical path, and the methods of duration compression.

4. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

AFTER THE COMPLETION OF THIS PROJECT WORK, STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO:

- Apply and follow the Systems Development Life Cycle (SDLC).
- Evaluate systems requirements.
- Complete a problem definition.
- Evaluate a problem definition.
- Determine how to collect information to determine requirements.
- Perform and evaluate feasibility studies like cost-benefit analysis, technical feasibility, time feasibility and Operational feasibility for the project.
- Work on data collection methods for fact finding.
- Construct and evaluate data flow diagrams.
- Construct and evaluate data dictionaries.
- Evaluate methods of process description to include structured English, decision tables and decision trees.
- Evaluate alternative tools for the analysis process.
- Create and evaluate such alternative graphical tools as systems flow charts and state transition diagrams.

- Select and evaluate the Software and Hardware requirement specifications.
- Plan the systems design phase of the SDLC.
- Distinguish between logical and physical design requirements.
- Design and evaluate system outputs and inputs.
- Design and evaluate validity checks for input data.
- Design and evaluate user interfaces for input.
- Design and evaluate file structures to include the use of indexes.
- Estimate storage requirements.

- Explain the various file update processes based on the standard file organizations.
- Decide various data structures.
- Construct and evaluate entity-relationship (ER) diagrams for RDBMS related projects.
- Perform normalization for the un-normalized tables for RDBMS related projects
- Decide the various processing systems to include distributed, client/server, online and others.
- Perform project cost estimates using various techniques.
- Schedule projects using both GHANTT and PERT charts.
- Perform coding for the project.
- Documentation requirements and prepare and evaluate systems documentation.
- Perform various systems testing techniques/strategies to include the phases of testing.
- Systems implementation and its key problems.
- Generate various reports.
- Be able to prepare and evaluate a final report.
- Brief the maintenance procedures and the role of configuration management in operations.
- To decide the future scope and further enhancement of the system.
- Plan for several appendices to be placed in support with the project report documentation.
- Work effectively as an individual or as a team member to produce correct, efficient, well organized and documented programs in a reasonable time.
- Recognize problems that are amenable to computer solutions, and knowledge of the tools necessary for solving such problems.
- Develop of the ability to assess the implications of work performed.
- Get good exposure and command in one or more application areas and on the software • Develop quality software using the software engineering principles
- Develop of the ability to communicate effectively.

Prescribed Textbook:

Information Technology Project Management by Kathy Schwalbe 9th Edition.

Recommended Textbook(s):

Contemporary Project Management, Plan Driven and Agile approaches, 5th Edition.

The Supervisor's Role

The supervisor's role is to guide the student, and ultimately the project. The supervisor marks the project proposal and ensures that the group's project proposal is feasible and at the right level for both diploma and degree. During the project, the supervisor will advise students on executing the work and advise on what to do in case of difficulties.

When it comes to the report, the supervisor can generally be expected to provide detailed comments on a selected draft chapter. Your supervisor will also be willing to read through a draft of the final report and provide either verbal or written feedback. Such requirements for feedback must be scheduled in advance (as part of the project plan)

The Student's Role

Students are expected to plan accordingly and complete their tasks on time. They are to ensure that the work of the group is coordinated and up to date. Part of the idea with the project is to equip students with interpersonal and time management skills. Your group will meet regularly with your supervisor and as needed with any outside client. The meetings will be chaired and recorded (minutes) by members of the group in rotation. The project group should also schedule their own meetings and minute them as well. The agenda should cover progress on agreed actions, new action points and specific issues to raise with your supervisor. Minutes include a record of attendance.

5. POINTS TO REMEMBER WHILE PREPARING FOR THE PROJECT

The **project documentation** may be about 50 to 80 pages (excluding coding). The project documentation details should not be too generic in nature. Appropriate project report documentation should be done, like, **how you have done the analysis, design, coding, use of testing techniques/strategies, etc., in respect of your project**. To be more specific, whatever the theory in respect of these topics is available in the reference books should be avoided as far as possible. **The project documentation should be in respect of your project only.** The project documentation should include the topics given below.

1. ***Table of Contents/Index with page numbering***

2. ***Introduction/Objectives***

3. ***Planning Phase***

   i. Identification of Need

   ii. Preliminary investigation

iii. Feasibility Study
iv. Project Planning

v. Project Scheduling (PERT Chart and Gantt Chart both)

vi. Software requirement specifications (SRS)

vii. Software Engineering Paradigm applied.

viii. Data models (like DFD), Control Flow diagrams, State Diagrams/Sequence diagrams, Entity Relationship Model, Class Diagrams/CRC Models/Collaboration Diagrams/Use-case Diagrams/Activity Diagrams depending upon your project requirements

4. System Design

i. Modularisation details
ii. Data integrity and constraints
iii. Database design, Procedural Design/Object Oriented Design
iv. User Interface Design
v. Test Cases (Unit Test Cases and System Test Cases)

5. Coding

i. Complete Project Coding
ii. Comments and Description of Coding segments
iii. Standardization of the coding
iv. Code Efficiency
v. Error handling
vi. Parameters calling/passing
vii. Validation checks

6. Testing

i. Testing techniques and Testing strategies used
ii. Testing Plan used
iii. Test reports for Unit Test Cases and System TestCases
iv. Debugging and Code improvement

7. System Security measures (Implementation of security for the project developed)

i. Database/data security
ii. Creation of User profiles and access rights

8. Cost Estimation of the Project along with Cost Estimation Model

9. Reports (sample layouts should be placed)

10. ***Future scope and further enhancement of the Project***

11. ***Bibliography***

12. ***Appendices (if any)***

13. ***Glossary***

6. PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

The project documentation should be printed with single line spacing on A4 paper. All the pages, tables and figures must be numbered. Tables and figures should contain titles.

Assessment guidelines for project evaluation

Each component of the project work carries its own weight, so students are strongly advised to concentrate on all the sections given in the project report formulation.

In this section, we have given a few general parameters as checkpoints for the assessment of any software development project. You can note these points and emphasise them during the project documentation preparation and examination.

Basically, assessment will be based on the quality of your work, the technical merit of the project and the project execution. Technical merit attempts to assess the quality and depth of the intellectual effort that the student has put into the project. Project execution is concerned with assessing how much work you have put in.

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7. TIMELINE & DELIVERABLES

NO.	PROJECT PHASES	PROJECT DELIVARABLES	ALLOCATED MARKS	SUPERVISOR MARK	DUE DATE
1.	**PROJECT PROPOSAL**	One-to-two-page proposal outlining your design. In this proposal the project group must clearly describe the following: • The purpose of the project • The implementation language • The SDLC model chosen for the project	10%		**MARHC 23RD, 2026**
2.	**PLANNING PHASE**	2.1. Identification of need	25%		**APRIL 13TH, 2026**
		2.2. Preliminary Investigation			
		2.3. Feasibility Study (Technical, Operational, Economical)			
		2.4. Project Planning			
		2.5. Project Scheduling (PERT Chart and Gantt Chart both)			
		2.6. Software Requirement Specification			
		2.7. Data Models			

3.	**ANALYSIS PHASE**	3.1 Introduction	20%		**MAY 11TH, 2026**
		3.2 Information Gathering methodology (Observation, participatory, Interviews)			
		3.3 Analysis of existing system			
		3.4 Data Analysis (Data Integrity & Constraints)			
		3.5 Weakness of the Current System			
		3.6 Analysis of the Proposed System (Functional Requirements)			
		3.7 Non-Functional Requirements			
		3.8 Data Modeling for Proposed System			
4.	**SYSTEM DESIGN PHASE**	4.1 Introduction	20%		**JUNE 8TH, 2026**
		4.2 System Design (Description of Proposed System)			
		4.3 Architectural Design (Software Architectural			

		Design, Hardware Architectural Design, Network Architectural Design, class diagram)			
		4.4 Physical Design			
		4.5 Database Design			

		4.6 Program Design (Program Pseudo code)			
		4.7 Interface Design (Menu Interface Design, Input Design, Output Design)			
		4.8 Security back up design (Software concern)			
5.	**IMPLEMENTATION PHASE**	5.1 Introduction	25%		**JUNE 29TH, 2026**
		5.2 Coding			
		5.3 Testing			
		5.4 System Testing (Test Case, Evaluation of the testing results)			
		5.5 Installation (Software Application Installation)			

Note: Project Documentation carries 50% of the overall project and Project presentation by the overall individual student will carry 50% of project.